MERCY'S ANATOMY

Document MA-008: Queens Grace Hospital, History and World

Canon Lock v2.2. As of July 1, 2005. Also locks the Foundation's role equivalent (see §11)

STATUS: LOCKED IN. Queens Grace Hospital is a Level I trauma center and independent teaching hospital in Long Island City, Queens. It was founded in **1889** by a formerly enslaved Civil War nurse and a Howard-trained physician, to treat the people every other hospital turned away. It is the equivalent of Seattle Grace Hospital. It is renamed **Queens Grace Hudson Mercy Hospital** during Season 6 and **Bullock Sloan Memorial Hospital** during Season 9.

At a glance (July 1, 2005)	
Address	One Grace Plaza, Jackson Avenue at Thomson Avenue, Long Island City, NY 11101, two blocks from Court Square
Founded	Sunday, October 6, 1889, as the Grace Infirmary for the Sick Poor, Hunters Point
Named Queens Grace	Saturday, January 1, 1898, the day Long Island City became part of the Borough of Queens
Motto	*Gratia sine pretio* ('Grace without price')
Designation	NYS-designated Level I Adult Trauma Center; Regional Burn Unit; Pediatric Trauma Center (Level II)
Beds / operating rooms	612 beds; 24 operating rooms, including 2 hybrid ORs
ER visits (FY2005)	about 101,000 per year
Teaching	ACGME-accredited residencies in 12 specialties, including the 7-year academic General Surgery track (MA-004)
Staff	about 5,900 employees
Payer mix	54% Medicaid or uninsured: the mission, and the reason for the deficit
Finances (FY2005)	$38 million operating deficit, and getting worse (this sets up the Season 6 merger)
Colors	Crimson and slate. The crest is a lantern over the Queensboro Bridge.

1. Founding: Hannah Grace Lockwood and Dr. Samuel Pell (1889)

Hannah Grace Lockwood (1838-1921) was born enslaved in Petersburg, Virginia. In 1856 she escaped north on the Underground Railroad to Weeksville, Brooklyn's free Black community. During the Civil War she nursed soldiers of the United States Colored Troops, and she came home with a surgeon's knowledge and nobody willing to call her one. By the 1880s she was the midwife and street nurse of Hunters Point, the factory district of what was then the independent **City of Long Island City**: oil refineries, glue works, rail yards, and immigrant and Black workers whom no hospital would admit.

Dr. Samuel Everett Pell (1851-1930) graduated from Howard University's medical department in 1878. He was refused privileges at every hospital in Brooklyn and Manhattan, so he practiced out of his kitchen. He and Lockwood met over a refinery explosion victim in 1888, whom they saved together on a butcher's table.

On **Sunday, October 6, 1889**, they opened the **Grace Infirmary for the Sick Poor** in a three-story rowhouse on Vernon Avenue with eleven beds, Lockwood's oil lamp and one rule painted over the door: **"Enter. You are welcome here."** 'Grace' came from Hannah's middle name, and from the fact that they charged nothing to anyone who couldn't pay. When Long Island City was consolidated into Greater New York on **January 1, 1898**, the board renamed it **Queens Grace Hospital** to claim the new borough as home.

Lockwood and Pell are historical figures within the story. They appear only in flashbacks, portraits and legend unless they're cast later.

2. Timeline

Date	Event
Sun., Oct. 6, 1889	The Grace Infirmary opens on Vernon Avenue: 11 beds.
Sat., Jan. 1, 1898	Renamed Queens Grace Hospital at the consolidation of Greater New York.
Tue., Mar. 30, 1909	The Queensboro Bridge opens, and with it the 'Bridge Ward' for construction and traffic injuries. QGH becomes the bridge's hospital.
1918	Influenza pandemic. QGH stays open when others close, and 41 staff die. Their names are first on the Wall of Grace.
Sat., May 14, 1927	The Art Deco 'Old Main' tower opens on Jackson Avenue, 14 stories, paid for by a borough-wide 'Penny for Grace' drive.
1949	First fully integrated surgical residency in Queens.
1964-65	QGH physicians staff the Medical Committee for Human Rights in Mississippi. Young Dr. Joan Mercer volunteers.
Fri., Apr. 5, 1968	The night after Dr. King's assassination, QGH's ER treats 200 patients, and the staff hold a vigil on the roof that becomes the Roof tradition.
1968	The brutalist Pell Pavilion (surgery and ICUs) opens.

Date	Event
Mon., Nov. 3, 1975	At the height of the NYC fiscal crisis, the city tries to defund QGH. The 'Save Grace' march crosses the Queensboro Bridge and the hospital is spared.
Wed., Jul. 13, 1977	The NYC blackout. QGH's backup generator fails at 10:40 PM, and surgeons finish four operations by flashlight with Lockwood's lamp lit in the lobby.
1983	One of New York's first dedicated AIDS wards opens on 6 West, at a time when other hospitals left meal trays outside patients' doors.
1986	The Lockwood Children's Wing opens.
Mon., Apr. 2, 1990	NYS Level I Trauma designation.
1993	Dr. Natasha Donohue joins as Chief of OB/GYN.
1999	Natasha Donohue named Chief of Surgery, the first woman and the first OB/GYN to hold the post.
Tue., Sept. 11, 2001	QGH mobilizes a triage line on the Hunters Point waterfront facing the burning towers. Few patients come. The staff never forget the waiting.
Thu., Aug. 14, 2003	The Northeast blackout. The generators hold this time, and the staff ring the Grace Bell at midnight.
Fri., Jul. 1, 2005	**S1E1.** The new surgical intern class arrives. The series begins.

3. The Campus

Place	What it is	Story use
Old Main	The 1927 Art Deco tower (14 floors) on Jackson Avenue, with administration, wards and the Chief's office (corner office, 9th floor, Manhattan view).	Power, politics, the Chief's door
The Pell Pavilion	The 1968 surgical tower: 24 ORs, ICUs, and the post-op floors.	Surgery, the heart of the show
The Gallery	Glass-walled observation decks above ORs 1 through 4.	Interns watch, rivals judge, lovers stare
The Pit	The Emergency Department and its trauma bays, entered from the Thomson Avenue ambulance bay.	Trauma, chaos, cold opens
The Tunnel	The 1927 basement corridor connecting Old Main to the Pell Pavilion, with abandoned gurneys and steam pipes.	Where interns nap, cry, eat and confess (the counterpart of Seattle Grace's tunnel)
The Roof	The flat roof of Old Main, facing west across the East River at the Midtown skyline, with the Pepsi-Cola sign glowing below.	Vows, breakups, oaths, late-night truth
The Lockwood Children's Wing	The 1986 pediatric building, with a mural of Hunters Point in 1889 in its lobby.	Marc's world (pediatric surgery)
On-call rooms	Bunk rooms on every surgical floor. Room 4C has a door lock that has been broken since 1994.	Sleep, rarely. Everything else, often.
Residents' Lounge	A sagging couch, a sticky microwave, and the board where the day's cases are assigned and fought over.	The morning case-assignment fight
The Cafeteria	The ground floor of Old Main, Miss Hattie's kingdom. Oxtail Thursdays.	Gossip, alliances, comfort
The Helipad	Above the Pell Pavilion, added in 1991.	Big arrivals and bigger exits
Monty's on Jackson	The bar across Jackson Avenue, not hospital property but part of the world.	Where the series begins (June 30, 2005)

4. Traditions, Lore and Legends

- **Lockwood's Lamp.** Hannah Lockwood's original 1889 brass oil lamp stands in a glass case in the Old Main lobby. Hospital legend says it flickers before a disaster. (It's on a timer. Mostly.)
- **The Grace Bell.** A ship's bell salvaged from a Newtown Creek barge in 1889. It's rung once when a patient everyone gave up on walks out alive. It hasn't been rung since August 14, 2003.
- **The Wall of Grace.** A bronze wall in the lobby with the names of staff who died serving, from the 41 lost in 1918 to FDNY EMS partners lost on September 11, 2001.
- **The Dawn Oath.** At 5:30 AM on July 1, before their first shift, new interns climb to the Roof, face Manhattan as the rising sun behind them turns the towers gold, and recite Lockwood's words: *"Enter. You are welcome here."* It is S1E1's first image.

- **'Gracelings'.** The hospital's name for its interns. It's affectionate from nurses and an insult from attendings.
- **The Board.** The case-assignment whiteboard in the Residents' Lounge. Interns are known to arrive at 4:45 AM to get first pick.
- **The Bridge Rule.** Any trauma off the Queensboro Bridge comes to Grace first, by tradition since 1909 and by EMS protocol since 1990.
- **Rivalry with 'the Island'.** QGH staff call Manhattan hospitals 'the Island'. Manhattan calls QGH 'that place across the river.' Both sides mean it.

5. Leadership and Key Staff (July 1, 2005)

Role	Name
President and CEO	Dr. Sylvia Rountree
Chief of Surgery	Dr. Natasha Donohue
Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery	Dr. Robert Bullock
Chief of Medicine	Dr. Horace Whitlow
Chief of Anesthesiology	Dr. Edwin Mabry
Head ER Nurse	Nurse Gloria Pettiford
Executive Assistant to the Chief	Bernadette 'Bernie' Watkins
Lead OR Scrub Nurse	Nurse Yvette Banks
General Counsel	Franklin Bassett, Esq.
Chief of Security	Raymond 'Big Ray' Toles
Chaplain	Rev. Dr. Josiah Abernathy
Social Work	Celia Montague, LCSW
Supervising Resident, 2005 Intern Class	Dr. Elxa Bullock
Other department chiefs (Neuro, Ortho, Peds Surgery, Plastics, General)	Established as episodes require them

6. The 2005 Surgical Intern Class

Queens Grace matches **18 categorical surgical interns** for July 1, 2005. Six are series regulars: **Marc-Anthony Bullock, Amond Baker, Esther Smilley, Arianna Cummings, Harmony Divine and Raven Ellison**. The other twelve fill the halls, the cuts and the competition, and they're named as episodes need them. Under the 80-hour rule the interns work 28- to 30-hour calls every fourth night and earn $44,820 a year, which is the PGY-1 salary at QGH in 2005.

7. The Hospital's Three Names

Era	Name	How it happens
Seasons 1-6	Queens Grace Hospital	The 1898 name. Under 'Natasha's Wall' the hospital refuses Donohue Foundation money and runs on grit and a growing deficit.
Seasons 6-9	Queens Grace Hudson Mercy Hospital	During Season 6, near insolvency, QGH merges with Hudson Mercy Medical Center of Jersey City, and the two staffs collide. Shortly after, the Season 6 finale shooting tests the merged hospital.
Seasons 9-present	Bullock Sloan Memorial Hospital	During Season 9, after the Season 8 finale plane crash, the Victor Donohue Foundation and the surviving doctors buy the hospital. It's renamed for Grace Bullock (in a coma) and Malcolm Sloan (who dies). Old Main's lobby keeps Lockwood's Lamp and the Wall of Grace.

Hudson Mercy Medical Center (Jersey City, NJ) was founded in 1911 by the Mother AME Zion congregation of Jersey City as a hospital for Black dockworkers. It's proud, cash-poor and political, and its residents arrive in Season 6 convinced that Queens Grace is the one being absorbed.

8. The Neighborhood in 2005

- **Transit:** the 7 train at Court Square, the E/V at 23 St-Ely Av and the G at Court Square, plus the Hunters Point ferry to East 34th Street. Interns ride the 7 at 4:30 AM.
- **Food:** bodega egg-and-cheese, beef patties from Jackson Avenue spots, Vernon Boulevard diners, and Miss Hattie's oxtails.
- **Texture:** 5Pointz graffiti across the street, Silvercup Studios, the Pepsi-Cola sign, the half-built Queens West towers, the Citigroup tower over everything, and steam off the Sunnyside rail yards.
- **Change:** the 2001 rezoning is turning factory blocks into glass towers. QGH's patients are the people being priced out, which is a running theme.

9. In the News

NEW YORK DAILY NEWS

Thursday, July 14, 1977, Extra

FLASHLIGHT SURGEONS

Queens Grace docs finish four operations in the dark as city burns

LONG ISLAND CITY. When the lights went out across New York at 9:27 Wednesday night, Queens Grace Hospital's backup generator held for 73 minutes. Then it died.

"We had four patients open on the table," said one surgeon. "We had flashlights, a nurse holding a lamp from the lobby, and God. We finished all four." All four patients survived.

QUEENS CHRONICLE

Thursday, July 7, 2005

Queens Grace Welcomes 18 New Surgeons-in-Training

Interns take 'Dawn Oath' on hospital roof; Chief warns of 'the hardest year of their lives'

LONG ISLAND CITY. Eighteen new surgical interns climbed to the roof of Queens Grace Hospital at 5:30 a.m. last Friday, July 1, for a tradition dating to 1968, reciting the hospital's founding words as the sun rose behind them over Queens.

"Some of you will not finish," Chief of Surgery Dr. Natasha Donohue told the class. "The ones who do will never be the same."

The hospital, which posted a $38 million operating deficit last year, continues to treat more uninsured patients than any hospital in western Queens.

QueensGraceConfidential (Blogger), posted Saturday, July 2, 2005, 2:03 AM

"Day 1 report: 18 Gracelings in, one cried at the Dawn Oath (not naming names, Divine), one asked the Warden if there was a dress code for 'smiling' (Cummings, girl...), and the tall one with the dimples was spotted leaving Monty's on Thursday night NOT alone. On the night BEFORE day one?? Bold. Welcome to Grace, babies." Comments (22).

10. Canon Log Additions

ID	Established fact	Source
C-049	**The Victor Donohue Foundation fills the role of the Harper Avery Foundation.** The Donohue Award fills the role of the Harper Avery Award.	MA-008 §11
C-050	QGH was founded Sunday, October 6, 1889, by Hannah Grace Lockwood and Dr. Samuel Everett Pell, and renamed Queens Grace on January 1, 1898.	MA-008 §1
C-051	QGH is at One Grace Plaza, Jackson Ave at Thomson Ave, LIC. It is the counterpart of Seattle Grace.	MA-008
C-052	Campus landmarks: Old Main, the Pell Pavilion, the Gallery, the Pit, the Tunnel, the Roof, the Lockwood Children's Wing and on-call room 4C.	MA-008 §3
C-053	Traditions: Lockwood's Lamp, the Grace Bell (last rung August 14, 2003), the Wall of Grace, the Dawn Oath (S1E1's first image) and 'Gracelings'.	MA-008 §4
C-054	The 2005 categorical intern class numbers 18, six of them series regulars. PGY-1 salary: $44,820.	MA-008 §6
C-055	Hudson Mercy Medical Center was founded in 1911 in Jersey City by the Mother AME Zion congregation.	MA-008 §7

11. Amendment: The Foundation's Role

By creator ruling, **the Victor Donohue Foundation fills the role of the Harper Avery Foundation**. Every storyline in which the counterpart foundation appears (the award, the board seats, buying the hospital, and the later scandal-and-reckoning arc) maps onto the Victor Donohue Foundation. Because the Foundation and Victor stay '1978-present' and beloved by creator canon, the counterpart's scandal arc is redirected away from Victor himself (No-Nerf), and the Foundation keeps its name. The details are set when those episodes are built. MA-007 has been amended to match.

END OF MA-008. CANON LOCKED (v2.2).
Enter. You are welcome here.